

Verifying Disks

Disk It's often useful to verify a disk to make sure it's still readable—for example, when you haven't used a disk for a long time or when you're having any kind of trouble accessing the disk. The Verify operation reads all the blocks on the disk to ensure that they're all readable. Just click the icon you want to verify and select "Verify" from the Disk menu. If any blocks can't be read, the Finder will display the bad block numbers in a window.

File This low-level verification does not check the integrity of the files on the disk, nor does it ensure that the data contained in the disk is valid. (It's possible for each block on the disk to be perfectly readable, yet for the disk itself to be unusable due to corrupted folder data or other bad information stored on it.) To verify that each *file* on the disk can be read, click the disk icon and select "Validate" from the File menu. If any files can't be read, the Finder will display the names of the bad files in a window.

If either of these tests detects a problem on your disk, copy any readable files to another disk and stop using the bad disk immediately. Programs such as ProSel-16, Salvation-Deliverance, and RepairWorks can often retrieve some or all of the information from defective disks.

Note!

You can't Verify network volumes, since individual disk blocks are not available across an AppleShare network. You can, however, Validate network volumes.

Working With 3.5" Disks

We've already talked about one way to eject a 3.5" disk—by dragging its icon to the Trash. You can also eject a 3.5" disk by clicking its icon and selecting Put Away from the File menu, or by pressing ⌘-Y. This permanently ejects a 3.5" disk—the Finder will forget about it and stop displaying an icon. (This doesn't mean that you can't put the disk back in, only that the Finder won't keep track of it.)

To temporarily eject a 3.5" disk, simply press the eject button on the front of the drive, or click the disk's icon and select "Eject" from the Disk menu (or press ⌘-E). When you temporarily eject a disk, the Finder displays the disk as a *dimmed* icon, reminding you that it's not in any drive. If you try to work with that disk (for example, copy another disk or file onto it), the Finder will remind you to put the disk back into a drive.

This latter is the key to copying disks if you have a single 3.5" drive. You'll usually put the target disk in first, then eject it temporarily. Then you'll insert the source disk and drag it onto the dimmed icon of the target disk. The Finder will tell you when to switch disks and will ask for the disk it needs by name.

⑥ **New & Improved**

System 6 automatically detects 3.5" disk insertions when it requests a particular disk. There's no need to click "OK" or press Return when the computer asks for a 3.5" disk; just put the disk in any available drive.